

# Binxin Gao

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## Education

**University of Maryland**, Robert H. Smith School of Business Aug 2024-present  
**Ph.D. in Management**, College Park  
Independent Project: *"OpenAI or CloseAI? That is A Question: A Model & Some Empirical Evidences"*  
Mentors: *Prof. Serguey Braguinsky and Prof. Evan Starr*

**Columbia University**, Columbia Business School May 2016  
**M.Sc., Financial Economics**, Core GPA: 3.7/4.0 New York  
Thesis: *"Does Shanghai-Hong Kong Stock Connect really connect A-share and H-share market?"*  
Mentor: *Prof. Michael Johannes*

**Peking University**, Guanghua School of Management July 2014  
**B.Sc., Finance & Statistics**, Core GPA: 3.75/4.0 Beijing  
Honors Thesis: *"Non-linear Momentum Trading Strategies in Chinese Future Market"*  
Mentor: *Prof. Chenxu Li*

## Publications

**Gao, B., Li, C., Qiao, K. (2015).** *Non-linear Momentum Strategies: Theories and Applications in the Chinese Future Market*, Quarterly Journal of Finance, 9(1), pp. 23–58.

- 11 citations, 325 downloads.
- Recognized by top Chinese universities for tenure requirements.

## Research Experience

**Thesis Seminar at Columbia Business School** Feb 2016 – May 2016  
*supervised by Prof. Michael Johannes (chair of MSFE program)*

- Assessed Shanghai-Hong Kong Connect's impact on market efficiency using Difference-in-Differences and propensity score matching.
- Developed quantitative research skills across research design, data collection, analysis, and presentation.

**Behavioral Finance Project** Sep 2013 – Sep 2014  
*supervised by Prof. Chenxu Li, Ya Tang, Lei Lu at Peking University*

- Proposed a model drawing on financial intuitions by substituting "binary bet" with a double-step function, which represents waiting until the momentum signal reaches a threshold before trading, and introducing some hidden factors like Shibor
- Investigated all 660 contracts in 2012 thoroughly using MATLAB, located and elucidated the non-linear momentum effects in the Chinese future market as the first foray to fill in the blanks in both theory and industry

- Constructed trading strategies that significantly outperformed the traditional linear approach with double excess return and significantly improved Sharpe, and checked the robustness with trading data in 2013
- Independently completed the paper "Applications of Non-linear Momentum Trading Strategies in Chinese Future Market"

### **Stochastic Process Textbook Project**

Sep 2013 – Jun 2014

*Head Research Assistant at Guanghua School of Management*

- Co-authored the textbook "Applied Mathematical Methods in Finance Research" (ISBN: 978-7-301-31844-7) using LaTeX
- Organized group seminars and authored introductory documents on LaTeX for group members
- Replicated (Martin & Bana, 2012) in Matlab and SAS by collecting, cleaning, and analyzing high-frequency trading data

### **CBOE Market Volatility Index (VIX) Project**

Sep 2013 – Dec 2013

*CResearch Assistant for Prof. Chenxu Li at Peking University*

- Co-authored a working paper on the pricing of VIX derivatives under a general class of stochastic volatility models by combining the Ito-Taylor expansion with a Markov chain Monte Carlo simulation
- Conducted literature review on the term structure of implied volatility and attended conferences (eg. Jim Gatheral's talk)

## Professional Experience

### **CCB International (China) Limited, Hangzhou**

June 2022 – April 2024

*Vice President, Fund Management Department*

- Led deal origination and execution in technology and consumer sectors, managing an investment portfolio across AI, SaaS, optoelectronics, etc.
- Closed 3 transactions worth ¥180M, mentoring associates and overseeing valuation modeling, due diligence, and SPA negotiation.
- Cultivated relationships with LPs, local government, and PE/VC networks to source over 100 partnership opportunities.

### **Tencent, Shanghai/Shenzhen**

Nov 2020 – Apr 2022

*Product Expert, Corporate Development Group (AMS)*

- Sourced and evaluated 20+ strategic partnerships in consumer and tech sectors, including XR and IP products.
- Built AI tools leveraging CV and NLP algorithms, improving advertiser ROI for key clients (total budget: ¥50M).
- Conducted A/B tests, authored product requirement documents, and advised clients on strategies.

### **NetEase Games, Hangzhou**

July 2016 – Sep 2019

*Senior Game Designer, Interactive Entertainment Business Group*

- Designed core features for the MMORPG "Chuliuxiang," achieving 10M downloads and 3M

DAU.

- Led cross-functional teams to create innovative gameplay elements, such as terrain interaction and auction systems.
- Founded a Hanfu brand and collaborated with Dunhuang Research Institute on 16 original designs, garnering 10k+ followers.

## — Honors & Awards

- **OpenAI Researcher Access Program (2025):** Supporting part of my ongoing projects.
- **Province Award of Excellence (2015):** Stipend awarded to top-performing overseas students.
- **Photography (2013):** 1st Prize out of 1,178,307 in National Photography Competition.
- **National Business Case Analysis Contest (2013):** Best Individual and Team Awards.

## — Skills

**Research Methods:** DID, RDD, IV, SEM, Fixed/Random Effects, Case Studies, Survey Design.

**Programming Languages:** Python, R, VBA, MATLAB, SQL, C++.

**Software:** Stata, Bloomberg, SAS, SPSS, Capital IQ.

**Languages:** English (TOEFL 112, GMAT 770), Mandarin (Native).

## — Interests

Hanfu vlogger with 60k+ followers, Tea ceremony, snowboarding, photography, calligraphy.